

WORK FROM HOME POLICY

PURPOSE:

This policy outlines the terms and conditions under which employees of DataSafeguard India Private Limited may work from home. The purpose is to provide flexibility while ensuring employees remain productive, engaged, and aligned with company goals.

1. ELIGIBILITY FOR WORK FROM HOME (WFH)

Employees of **DataSafeguard** may be allowed to work from home based on the following conditions:

- **Role Suitability:** Roles that do not require physical presence in the office are eligible for WFH arrangements. These typically include IT development, design, project management, and other software-related functions.
- **Manager Approval:** WFH is not an automatic right. Remote work is not available in locations where DSG operates its own or partner offices. It must be approved by the employee's manager or team lead on a case-by-case basis, depending on project requirements and individual performance.
- **Trial Period:** Newly hired employees may be required to complete a probationary period (e.g., 3 months or 6 months) before being eligible for WFH, at the discretion of management.

2. Work Hours and Availability

- **Standard Working Hours:** Employees working from home are expected to adhere to the company's standard working hours as per time zone (e.g., IST, PST, CST etc) unless alternative arrangements are approved.
- **Availability:** Employees must be available for virtual meetings (Cameras must remain on, and the session should be attended using a PC rather than a mobile phone), calls, and collaboration during work hours and should be responsive to emails, messages, and calls.
- **Breaks:** Employees are encouraged to take breaks as they would in the office to maintain productivity and well-being.

3. Work Environment

- **Dedicated Workspace:** Employees are encouraged to have a quiet, comfortable, and organized workspace to minimize distractions and ensure focus on tasks.
- **Internet and Power Backup:** Employees are responsible for ensuring reliable internet connectivity and, where possible, power backup to avoid disruptions during work hours.
- **Health and Safety:** It is the employee's responsibility to ensure a safe working environment, free from hazards.

4. Communication and Collaboration

- **Communication Tools:** Employees are required to use company-approved communication tools (e.g., Microsoft Outlook, Microsoft Teams, Zoom) for collaboration with team members.
- **Meetings:** All scheduled meetings (e.g., daily stand-ups, Product Strategy, Product reviews) must be attended unless prior arrangements are made. Video meetings may be required to ensure engagement.
- **Reporting and Progress Updates:** Employees must provide regular updates on their tasks and product progress through the agreed channels (e.g., Jira, Trello, or similar task management tools).

5. Security and Data Protection

- **Confidentiality:** Employees must ensure that all company data, intellectual property, and client information remain confidential and are protected from unauthorized access while working from home.
- **Compliance with IT Policies:** Employees must follow the company's IT security policies, including the use of VPNs, encryption, and password protection to safeguard sensitive data.
- **Use of Company Equipment:** Employees may be provided with company-owned devices (laptops, software). Any damage, loss, or technical issues should be reported to the IT or HR department immediately.

6. Performance and Accountability

- **Task Completion:** Employees are expected to complete assigned tasks within deadlines, maintaining the same level of performance as in-office work.
- **Performance Monitoring:** Supervisors may regularly monitor productivity through work output, project status updates, and performance reviews to ensure remote work is effective.
- **Deliverables:** Clear deliverables must be defined at the start of each WFH period, and employees are responsible for meeting these deliverables within agreed timelines.

7. Attendance and Time Off

- **Sick Leave:** If an employee is unwell and unable to work, they must inform their manager as per the company's standard sick leave policy.
- **Personal Time Off (PTO):** Any requests for personal time off or leaves must follow the usual process for requesting leave through the HR system.
- **Absenteeism:** Employees must communicate in advance if they are unable to work during normal working hours due to personal or family emergencies.

Please note: - Working from home (WFH) should not be utilized as a substitute for Sick Leave (SL) or Paid Time Off (PTO), either partially or fully.

8. Equipment and Expenses

- **Company-Provided Equipment:** The company may provide equipment such as laptops, software licenses, and other tools necessary for employees to work effectively from home.
- **Reimbursement of Expenses:** If employees incur business-related expenses (e.g., high-speed internet, software), these must be pre-approved by the manager. The company may reimburse approved expenses upon submission of receipts.

9. Technical Support

- **IT Support:** Employees experiencing technical issues must report them to the IT department. Basic troubleshooting should be done by the employee before escalating.
- **Responsibility for Personal Devices:** If employees use their own devices for work purposes, they must ensure these devices meet security standards set by the company and are not compromised by malware or unauthorized access.

10. Work-from-Home Days

- **Standard WFH Days:** Employees may be allowed a specific number of WFH days per week or month, depending on project needs, and as agreed upon with their manager.
- **Full-Time Remote Work:** Employees whose roles do not require office presence may request full-time remote work, subject to management approval and periodic review.
- **Emergency WFH:** In case of unforeseen events (e.g., natural disasters, health pandemics), the company may mandate or permit temporary work-from-home arrangements for all employees.

11. Review and Termination of WFH Arrangement

- **Review Process:** WFH arrangements may be reviewed periodically by management to assess their effectiveness. Adjustments may be made as necessary based on performance and business needs.
- **Termination of WFH:** The company reserves the right to terminate WFH privileges if an employee's performance declines or if there are concerns about their ability to meet work expectations remotely. Employees will be informed in advance of any such changes.

12. Amendments to the Policy

DataSafeguard Inc. & DataSafeguard India Private Limited reserves the right to amend this policy as needed to reflect changes in operations, laws, or business requirements. Any changes will be communicated in writing to all employees.